

Milestone 02 – Improve Script and Metadata Documentation

C.J. Tinant

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1 Overview of v1.5

This milestone focuses on strengthening project transparency and reproducibility by embedding documentation within analysis folders and formalizing metadata management.

1.1 Goal

Enhance clarity, reproducibility, and maintainability of all project scripts by standardizing documentation headers, comments, and auxiliary files.

2 Project Structure

```
FFA_regional-skew/
.gitignore           # Prevents sensitive/local files from being pushed
arcgis_project/      # ArcGIS Pro .aprx project and supporting layers
CHANGELOG.Rmd        # Human-readable changelog (semantic versioning)
data/                # Raw, processed, meta, intermediate, and QA data
docs/                # Documentation, workflow notes, metadata, checklists
FFA_regional-skew.Rproj # RStudio project file (keep in root)
notebooks/           # Ad hoc .Rmd/.qmd experiments (empty or minimal)
notes/               # Team notes, meeting logs, brainstorm (convert to .md/.qmd)
R/                   # Analysis scripts (milestone-organized)
  01_download/       # Download process raw data
  02_clean_validate/ # QA scripts and validation checks
  03_covariates/      # Covariate extraction
  04_modeling/        # Statistical modeling (GAMs, Elastic Net, etc.)
  06_eval/            # Model diagnostics, residuals, validation
  utils/              # Reusable functions (organized by domain)
README.md            # GitHub-readable overview and navigation aid
README.Rmd           # Editable RMarkdown version
reports/             # Knitted .Rmd/.qmd milestone reports
results/             # Manuscript-ready figures, models, and outputs
sandbox/             # Staging area for review
```

3 v1.5 – Improve Script and Metadata Documentation

4 v1.5 Tasklist

Step	Task	Status
2.1	Standardize header blocks across all R scripts	[]
2.2	Add README.md to each R/ subfolder	[]
2.3	Ensure all scripts are self-contained	[]
2.4	Review document dependencies	[]
2.5	Review data/meta/data_dictionary.csv to define covariates	[]
2.6	Standardize use of .Rmd and .md for all folders	[]
2.7	Develop log_README.md templates to include in R/ and data/	[]
2.8	Link README-style metadata to milestone logs	[]
2.9	Commit and push changes as tag v0.5-docs-enhancement	[]

4.1 Description of Tasks Completed or In Progress

4.1.1 2.1 Standardize header blocks across all R scripts

Check the following are included in all scripts: - Script Name: 01m_download_ned.R - Author: Charles Jason Tinant — with ChatGPT 4o - Date Created: - Last Updated: - Change Log: - Purpose: - Workflow Summary: - Input/Data URLs - Outputs - Dependencies - Related Milestone Reports - Notes

4.1.2 2.2 Add README files to each major script directory

The README should include the following:

- High level workflow summaries

- A highlight of important scripts and expected outputs
- Links to data directories and relevant logs

4.1.3 2.3 Ensure all scripts are self-contained:

- Use `here()` for all file paths
- Clearly load libraries at top
- Minimize hard-coded paths or variables

4.1.4 2.4 Document dependencies:

- Ensure that each script lists required packages
- Consider using a `renv` or `DESCRIPTION` file for reproducibility

4.1.5 2.5 Improve inline comments:

- Add clarifying comments to non-obvious code
- Remove commented-out legacy code unless justified
- Cross-reference milestones or related scripts at the top of each file

4.1.6 Suggested Tags and Commit Messages

If you're versioning as you go:

Commit message:

Add standardized documentation headers to all R/01_download scripts; draft README for data download work

Tag for milestone completion:

v1.5.0-docs or v02-complete

5 Summary

This milestone strengthens reproducibility by formalizing internal documentation practices. It includes README templates for R/ subfolders, a planned data dictionary, and introduces `log_README.md` documentation inside each milestone to clarify roles, assumptions, and outputs.